

Tablet OS

There seems to be a sudden proliferation of netbook OSes, will the next thing be OSes for Tablets?

each app is basically a page loaded in a Firefox window. .

Prominently at the centre, is a “Get Started” icon. Use this to setup and optimise Jolicloud for your device. You can setup a Jolicloud account, which will be authenticated over email with a code. You will have to setup a username and password, which is different from the username and password for the computer. This is a Jolicloud profile, which you can either fill up, or you can simply login using your Facebook details, which does not need an authentication message.

There is also an option here to select the model of the netbook you are using. If you are installing Jolicloud on a desktop or nettop, just choose “Other Unrecognised Machine”. If you are using a netbook, chances are that your model number

obscure tabs and brought to the forefront, keyboard shortcuts is one example. By default, Jolicloud should apply most of the relevant shortcuts, including the multimedia keys, but you can further customise the setup or choose options that you are more comfortable with it.

Installing applications

To get on to the Application Manager, click on the Yellow Down Arrow along the top bar. This starts the application Dashboard, which contains a large database of both traditional desktop applications and web applications into a single interface. This means that you can install GIMP and Pixlr, one a desktop image editing application, and the other a cloud image editing



The Jolicloud application manager

is listed in the long list of supported models (98 per cent of all netbooks).

Once this is done, you can head over to the Preferences and Administration sections of the dashboard for further customisation. The view is similar to the Control Panel in Windows or Mandriva, so even users new to Linux should be at home tweaking the settings. There are some useful settings that have been removed from

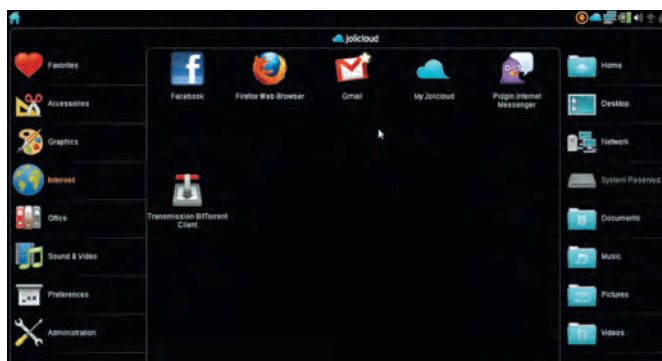
application alongside. When you run a cloud based application, the web page is opened as a separate Firefox window in full screen mode, so there is no discernible difference between a web app and a desktop app, which is great.

There are featured web applications from different providers with one notable exception, being VLC. The applications are sorted into groups based on Accessories, Development, Education,

Dropbox

You can store all your documents on the cloud using Dropbox, a partner of Jolicloud

Workshop



Internet applications on Jolicloud

Games, Graphics, Internet, Office, Sound and Video. Additionally, each category can be listed according to different priorities, either by popularity or date. You will find many familiar such as Last.fm, Dropbox, Facebook, Gmail and Spotify among others. There are also a whole bunch of little known web applications that are just waiting to be discovered.

You can also install traditional desktop applications using the application manager. If there are a few must have windows applications that you simple cannot do without, then you can install Wine as well, and try to run the Windows applications on a Wine layer. This is not advisable if you are multi-booting though, as it is a waste of resources.

Once web applications are installed, they are pinned to the top bar in the form of tiny icons that can be clicked to open the window. Jolicloud does not accumulate web applications into tabs in a single browser window. One strange thing that users will have to learn to live with is the lack of a restore or minimise button. Although you can open multiple windows, they are always maximized, and you have to click on the home icon on the top left corner of the window, which is the link to the dashboard, and doubles up as a rudimentary

start button. The location of the “close” button is right next to the address bar on the window, which is about halfway into the top bar. This minor deviation is easy to get used to, as there is a lot of screen real estate saved over for actually using the web or the applications. There are some grey areas though. Installing the desktop Last.fm client is a little painful and roundabout. You can choose to install Chrome on the machine, instead of the default Firefox if you prefer Google’s browser for any reason. Most audio and video files play out of the box, so codecs are not really a problem with Jolicloud.

Should you use Jolicloud?

Jolicloud is pre-beta, so despite the apparent lack of bugs, there are many things left to be polished. Jolicloud is one of the more feature rich and easy to use free netbook operating systems available. While Jolicloud offers a great range of net content, there is always the offline system to fall back on, and the internet is not strictly necessary to work on Jolicloud. Connecting to Wi-Fi is reportedly easier on Jolicloud than on Moblin or Chrome, so if you have significant problems with other Linux based netbook distros, Jolicloud is the perfect OS to try. **d**